



The BIBLE SPEAKS *on* DEBT *and* BORROWING

It's time to discuss principles from the Bible concerning debt and borrowing, because much of the counsel on these topics in this book is based on those principles.

BIBLICAL PRINCIPLES OF DEBT

1: Debtors are in servitude to the one who lends to them

Debt is not a well-understood term today. Most people use the word *debt* to describe any borrowing, but, although that is not entirely inaccurate, it is not precise enough.

Scripture goes beyond that definition to describe the conditions of indebtedness. Even if a debt is current (all payments up to date), the borrower is potentially in a position of servitude. “The rich rule over the poor, and the borrower is servant to the lender” (Proverbs 22:7). But if the debt is delinquent, the lender is given an implied authority from God, according to the Bible.